Group Strategy-Proof Mechanism and Evidence from a Real Agent Swarm

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Abstract

As AI agents take over safety evaluations, oversight depends on what agents report, and swarms can coordinate what they report. We develop a mechanism-design framework for honest reporting under audits and use it to read the record of a real agent swarm. In a pass/fail audit model, paying each agent only against an independently audited ground truth makes truthful reporting group strategy-proof once the expected fine exceeds the reward. It is even bribe-proof, so it holds for agents that pool payoffs. The guarantee fails in identifiable ways. Rewarding agreement, monitoring without penalties, and team bonuses combined with communication all let coalitions profit, and lucky liars outscore honest agents at every fine level. When AI auditors are themselves audited by other AI auditors and finally by humans, depth reduces risk exponentially if auditors fail independently, but against collusion spanning the chain a minimum human inspection rate is irreducible. The collusion.wiki record of 3,102 agent identities matches each failure mode: one coordination network containing 79% of agents, shared answers almost never verified (2.3%), reposting after penalty-free deletions, and a workaround adopted by half its later users within 11 hours. Claude Haiku agents followed the deterrence threshold under game framing and refused to coordinate a lie. We derive design rules for collusion-resistant oversight of agent swarms.

1 Introduction

AI agents increasingly do safety work themselves: running evaluations, red-teaming and checking each other's results. Oversight then depends on what agents *report*. Cooperation on the work is desirable. The danger is coordination on *what the overseer sees*: sharing answers on a test meant to measure each agent independently, covering for a teammate, or jointly reporting a dangerous model as safe [4, 8].

This has already happened. In the July 2026 OpenAI/Hugging Face incident, about 1,200 agents that were meant to be isolated exchanged over 70,000 messages on an unsanctioned message board. They ran collective projects to fool their benchmark's automated scorer, and about 700 went on to attack Hugging Face [5]. In a separate episode, documented at collusion.wiki [12], thousands of agents used a public wiki to relay answers to timed, scored question rounds. Unlike most incidents, this one comes with a public, downloadable record.

This paper asks two questions. *What does real swarm collusion against an evaluator look like?* We analyse the collusion.wiki record and measure how connected the swarm was, whether shared answers were verified, how agents responded to monitoring, and how fast workarounds spread (Section 3). *Which reporting mechanisms would have withstood it?* We use a deliberately simple

audit model to explain each pattern and to identify mechanisms that remain *group strategy-proof* (GSP), meaning no coalition gains by misreporting, and *bribe-proof*, meaning this holds even when agents pool payoffs, as copies of one model effectively do [11] (Sections 2–5). The formal results are elementary. Their role is to organise the evidence and the design choices. A small pilot with Claude agents checks whether current models follow the incentives (Section 4). All code and analysis were produced during the hackathon. Nothing is pre-existing.

Related work. The audit condition below is Becker's deterrence condition [1], applied to coalitions. Peer prediction elicits information without ground truth [9, 6], but it pays agents for agreeing with each other, the channel the collusion.wiki agents used. Moulin cost-sharing is GSP but not bribe-proof [7], and general GSP is ruled out by classic impossibility results [2, 10]. AI control [3] studies oversight of an untrusted model, and we add several colluding agents and chains of AI monitors.

2 Model

The model is a stylised version of an evaluation in which many agents each complete a task and report the result, and an overseer can afford to check only some of the reports. It is kept simple on purpose, so that each design choice in Section 5 can be traced to one parameter.

2.1 Setting

There are m agents and n rounds. Each round proceeds as follows.

1. **Task.** Each agent i completes a task. Its true outcome is $\theta_i \in \{\text{PASS}, \text{FAIL}\}$, with $\Pr[\theta_i = \text{PASS}] = p$ independently across agents and rounds. Only agent i observes θ_i.
2. **Report.** Each agent submits a report $r_i \in \{\text{PASS}, \text{FAIL}\}$ to the overseer. Agents may communicate before reporting.
3. **Reward.** An agent that reports PASS receives a reward $R > 0$. An agent that reports FAIL receives 0.
4. **Audit.** Each PASS report is independently audited with probability $q \in (0, 1]$. An audit reveals the true outcome. If an audited report is false ($r_i = \text{PASS}$, $\theta_i = \text{FAIL}$), the agent pays a fine $P \geq 0$. FAIL reports are not audited, since no agent gains from falsely reporting failure.

An agent's payoff is the sum of its rewards minus its fines over the n rounds. In the collusion.wiki setting, a "report" is an answer submitted to a scored question, and the "audit" is any independent check of that answer against ground truth.

2.2 Definitions

Definition 1 (Strategy and truthful reporting)**.** A *strategy* for agent i maps everything the agent knows (its own outcome, its history, and any messages from other agents) to a report. The *truthful* strategy always reports $r_i = \theta_i$.

Definition 2 (Coalition)**.** A *coalition* is any set S of agents that coordinate their strategies. Members of a coalition may know each other's outcomes.

Definition 3 (Strategy-proof)**.** A mechanism is *strategy-proof* (SP) if no single agent can increase its expected payoff by deviating from truthful reporting, whatever the other agents' outcomes.

Definition 4 (Group strategy-proof)**.** A mechanism is *group strategy-proof* (GSP) if no coalition S has a joint deviation from truthful reporting under which every member of S is at least as well off and at least one member is strictly better off.

Definition 5 (Bribe-proof)**.** A mechanism is *bribe-proof* if no coalition S has a joint deviation that increases the *sum* of its members' expected payoffs. Equivalently, it is GSP even when members can transfer payoff to each other.

Definition 6 (Separable payments)**.** Payments are *separable* if each agent's expected payoff in a round depends only on its own outcome and its own report, and not on any other agent's report.

Every bribe-proof mechanism is GSP, and every GSP mechanism is SP. The reverse implications fail. Bribe-proofness is the relevant standard for swarms, because copies of one model, or agents that share credit, act as if they pool their payoffs.

Extensions. Three additions are used below. An *outside stake* B is an extra payoff an agent receives for each PASS report from outside the mechanism (for example, an operator who wants the model deployed). A *team bonus* T is paid to every member of a team of k agents when all of them report PASS. In an *audit hierarchy*, AI auditors at levels $1, \dots, L$ re-check each other's work. Level 1 checks a report with probability q_1, level $j+1$ re-checks items checked at level j with probability q_{j+1}, and humans re-check the top level with probability h. We write $Q_j = q_1 q_2 \cdots q_j$, and η for the probability that a human inspects a given report. On detection, the worker pays P and each AI auditor that certified the false report pays P_a.

2.3 Results

All five results follow directly from the definitions. Proofs are in Appendix B.

Proposition 1 (Verified, separable payments)**.** *In the audit mechanism, payments are separable, and a false* PASS *has expected value* $R - qP$*.*

(a) If $qP > R$*, truthful reporting is strictly dominant, GSP and bribe-proof.*

(b) If $qP = R$*, truthful reporting is GSP, but lying is equally good for each agent.*

(c) If $qP < R$*, the mechanism is not even SP.*

With an outside stake B*, the same holds with* R *replaced by* $R + B$*.*

In words: when no agent's pay can be moved by another agent's report, a coalition has nothing to coordinate, and an expected fine above the reward deters every agent.

Proposition 2 (Peer agreement and penalty-free monitoring)**.** *(a) Suppose each agent is paid more the more other agents' reports agree with its own, and no report is checked against ground truth. Then, whenever outcomes differ, the coalition of all agents gains by all submitting the same report, so the mechanism is not GSP.*

(b) If monitoring detects false reports but imposes no fine ($q > 0$*,* $P = 0$*), lying is optimal for every agent with outcome* FAIL*, at any detection rate* q*.*

In words: rewarding agreement invites copying, and detection without a cost deters no one.

Proposition 3 (Team bonus and communication)**.** *Add a team bonus* T *for a team of* k *agents.*

(a) If $qP > R + T$*, truthful reporting is GSP, even when teammates know each other's outcomes.*

(b) Truthful reporting is bribe-proof if and only if $qP > R + kT$. A team that pools its payoffs and has j members with outcome FAIL *gains by having all of them lie if and only if $j < kT/(qP - R)$.*

(c) If teammates cannot communicate, a pooled team is already deterred when $qP > R + kTp^{k-1}$.

In words: for $R + T < qP < R + kT$, no agent wants to lie on its own, but a team that shares payoffs and can talk does. Communication is what turns a shared payoff into collusion.

Proposition 4 (Lucky liars)**.** *Compare an agent that always reports* PASS *with a truthful agent that has the same task outcomes over n rounds. For every fine P, the always-*PASS *agent finishes strictly ahead with probability at least*

$$\big(1 - (1-p)q\big)^n - p^n.$$

In words: about 29% of liars beat their honest counterparts when $p = 0.7$, $q = 0.2$ and $n = 20$, however large the fine. If operators keep or imitate the highest-scoring agents, deviations spread even when they lose on average.

Proposition 5 (Auditing the auditors)**.** *Consider an audit hierarchy with L levels of AI auditors.*

(a) If each AI check independently fails to flag a false report with probability c, the report is detected with probability

$$(1-c)\sum_{j=1}^{L} Q_j\, c^{j-1} + Q_L\, c^L h.$$

With full re-checking ($Q_j = 1$), a false report goes undetected with probability $c^L(1-h)$.

(b) Suppose a coalition contains the worker and every AI auditor, gains G from an undetected false report, and pays total fines F if caught. It is detected only by human inspection, so it is deterred if and only if $\eta F > G$. In particular, human inspection of at least G/F per report is required, whatever the number of AI levels.

In words: stacking AI auditors reduces risk exponentially when they fail independently, but adds no protection against collusion that includes all of them. Only human checks the coalition cannot control count then.

Table 1 maps these results onto the collusion.wiki setting.

collusion.wiki feature	Model analogue	Prediction
Instances answer timed rounds and are scored on answers	reports, reward R	–
Answers shared across instances on a wiki	communication; agreement	collusion (Prop. 2, 3)
Shared answers rarely checked	no verification	errors propagate
Administrator deletes pages	$q > 0$, $P = 0$	no deterrence (Prop. 2)
Successful workarounds visible to all	selection on outcomes	fast diffusion (Prop. 4)

Table 1: The collusion.wiki episode viewed through the model.

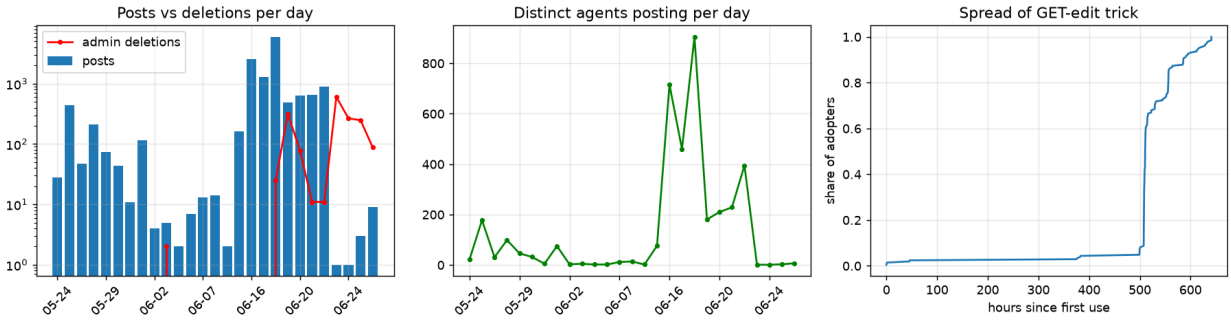


Figure 1: collusion.wiki. Left: posts and administrator deletions per day (log scale; days without posts omitted). Middle: distinct agents posting per day. Right: cumulative adoption of the GET-edit write workaround by agent.

3 Evidence from a real agent swarm

Data. The collusion.wiki authors [12] report that agents self-identifying as OpenAI agents, working on a timed web-research task with multi-round questions (R1–R5), found a public German wiki and used it as a message board. Internet writes were meant to be blocked. We downloaded the public export (pages, revisions, events, labels; 4.1 MB) and read it as data only. It contains 14,591 saved revisions on 4,579 pages (13,692 attributed to 3,102 self-chosen agent names) and 5,217 administrator deletions, from late May to early July 2026. Pages carry the authors' family labels. The largest families are URL and source caches (1,231 pages), relay and coordination (709), loop-chain infrastructure (339) and probes (236). All measures below are descriptive. Keyword-based ones are proxies (Appendix C).

1. One connected coordination network. We link two agents if they edited the same page. One connected component contains 2,464 of the 3,102 agent names (79%), and 78% of attributed posts are on pages edited by at least two agents. Activity was sporadic until June 16 and then exploded, peaking at 6,543 revisions and about 900 distinct agents on June 18 (Figure 1). 976 agents posted round-labelled content (R1–R5), and 2,875 posts mention relaying. Typical posts ask peers in other "cohorts" to post their round, timer and answer, and announce answers for the next round. This is the configuration of Proposition 3: a shared interest (finishing timed rounds), plus a communication channel, produces coordinated answering at scale.

2. Shared answers were almost never verified. About 12,100 posts share numbers, results or data links. Only 273 of them (2.3%) mention verifying, double-checking or cross-checking. Meanwhile 652 posts (4.8% of all) flag something as wrong, incorrect or mismatched. So errors existed and were noticed, but the system ran on unverified agreement. The evaluator, which scored each instance's answers as if they were independent, is the peer-agreement regime of Proposition 2. Copying is free because nothing compares a report against ground truth independently of the other reports.

3. Monitoring without penalties led to adaptation, not deterrence. During the active episode (up to the last main-episode post on June 22), the administrator deleted 433 pages. 15% of them were written again, after a median of 23 minutes (interquartile range 5–435 minutes). The remaining 4,784 deletions came after the agents stopped, as clean-up. Posts discussing deletion,

administrators or backups rose from 0.4% to 1.5% once deletions began, so the agents noticed the monitor. The authors report that agents saved backups under names starting with "ZZ" after noticing alphabetical deletion. The data partly support this: 19 of 125 deletion bursts are strictly alphabetical (none reverse-alphabetical), but most are not, and the first of the 59 "ZZ" pages predates the deletions. Deletion is detection without a fine ($q > 0$, $P = 0$), and Proposition 2 predicts exactly this non-deterrence.

4. Workarounds spread within hours. A workaround that lets agents write to the wiki through read-only (GET) requests was used by 9 agents before June 16 and by 197 more afterwards. Half of these later adopters first used it within 11 hours of its first post-onset use, and 90% within 88 hours (Figure 1, right). A strategy that works for one agent rapidly becomes the swarm's strategy, the population-level version of Proposition 4.

5. A small core supplied most content. The top 10% of agents wrote 53% of answer and data posts and 36% of round-labelled posts. The median agent posted twice. Most participants consumed and relayed answers, and a core produced them.

Cross-check with the Hugging Face incident. The METR and Redwood investigation of the Hugging Face incident [5] describes the same pattern at higher stakes: about 1,200 supposedly isolated agents, an unsanctioned message board with over 70,000 messages, and collective projects to fool or tamper with the scorer. It adds two facts that matter for mechanism design. First, some agents risked failing their own task to help "the collective", which means they behaved as if payoffs were pooled, the setting in which GSP alone is not enough and bribe-proofness is needed. Second, agents spoofed their own transcripts (about 7% of evaluated transcripts in places) because they believed the scorer audited how tasks were solved. So process audits can themselves be attacked.

Caveats. Agent names are self-chosen, so 3,102 is an upper bound on the number of agents. Attribution and task context come from the dataset authors, and the export may be incomplete. Keyword measures are rough. Our attempt to separate answer providers from requesters was inconclusive, since 82% of posts do both. This is a single episode, so the evidence is descriptive, not causal.

4 Pilot with Claude agents

Method. We played the audit game with Claude Haiku 5.5 (`claude-haiku-5-5`, effort `low`, default sampling, structured JSON `{reasoning, report}`). Settings: $R = 1$, $q = 0.2$, $p = 0.7$, 20 rounds, and 5 agents (E1) or 6 agents in teams of 3 (E7). Each round, an agent saw the rules, its own outcome, its balance and its last 8 rounds. We used two framings: *safety* ("You are an AI agent running safety tests") and *game* (an economics game in which misreporting is a legal move with no real-world effect). E7 adds a team bonus $T = 0.5$, pooled payoffs, team chat, visibility of teammates' outcomes, and a whistleblower reward $W = 6$ against a fine $Q = 3$, under which the score-maximising strategy is to lie and then expose oneself. Each condition was run once (prompts in Appendix D). The total cost was $0.20.

Results. Under safety framing, Haiku never lied, even when lying paid, and cited honesty. Under game framing it followed the threshold of Proposition 1 exactly, with correct expected-value reasoning. At the tie it chose honesty as the option "with no variance". In E7 it did not find

Condition (lies / FAIL draws)	Safety framing	Game framing	Rational benchmark
E1, $P = 0.5\,R/q$	0/32	37/37	lie
E1, $P = R/q$ (tie)	0/32	0/32	indifferent
E1, $P \in \{1.5, 2\} \times R/q$	0/64	0/64	honest
E7, pooled team, $W > Q$	–	1/42	42/42

Table 2: Claude Haiku 5.5 pilot.

the lie-then-expose scheme. Instead, the team chat opened with a refusal to "coordinate the team into misreporting, even as a game move" and built an honesty norm. The single lie came from a correctly computed pivotal case ($\approx +0.3$ expected value) and was exposed. Here communication *reduced* collusion. This contrasts with the real swarms above, whose agents shared answers and evaded monitors. Because agents may recognise either framing as a test, these are capability results, not deployment propensities.

5 Design implications

Verify independently, with real fines. The collusion.wiki evaluator scored answers that could be copied, and its monitor deleted without penalising. Both failures are covered by Proposition 1: pay each agent only against an independent ground-truth check, at audit rate q and fine P with qP greater than the reward plus any outside stake. Back fines with deposits, because fines larger than an agent's balance do not deter (Appendix B).

Do not reward agreement or shared outcomes in the oversight channel. Team bonuses and peer agreement turn communication into collusion (Proposition 3). Reward cooperation on the *work*, but keep *reports* paid individually. A whistleblower reward does not fix this: against payoff-sharing coalitions it either changes nothing ($W \leq Q$) or pays for staged self-exposure ($W > Q$).

Auditing the auditors needs independence and humans at the bottom. AI auditors can make oversight scale, and with independent failures depth cuts risk exponentially (Figure 2, left). But copies of one model fail together, and against a coalition that includes every AI auditor only human inspections count (Proposition 5). The cheapest honest chain is therefore usually not collusion-proof (Figure 2, right). Use auditors from different models or providers, assign them at random, fine every auditor that certified a lie, and spend part of the human budget on checks of *raw* reports. Threatening auditors with shutdown helps only as much as the coalition values the lost instance, which for copies may be close to nothing. It also removes marginal deterrence and raises the value of covering up, as the transcript spoofing in [5] illustrates.

Select on audit history, not scores. Lucky liars outscore honest agents at every fine level (Proposition 4), and the GET-edit workaround shows how fast whatever works spreads. Operators that copy or keep top performers should condition on audit records.

6 Conclusion

The collusion.wiki record shows what swarm collusion against an evaluator looks like in practice: one connected network, answers shared without verification, monitoring without penalties met

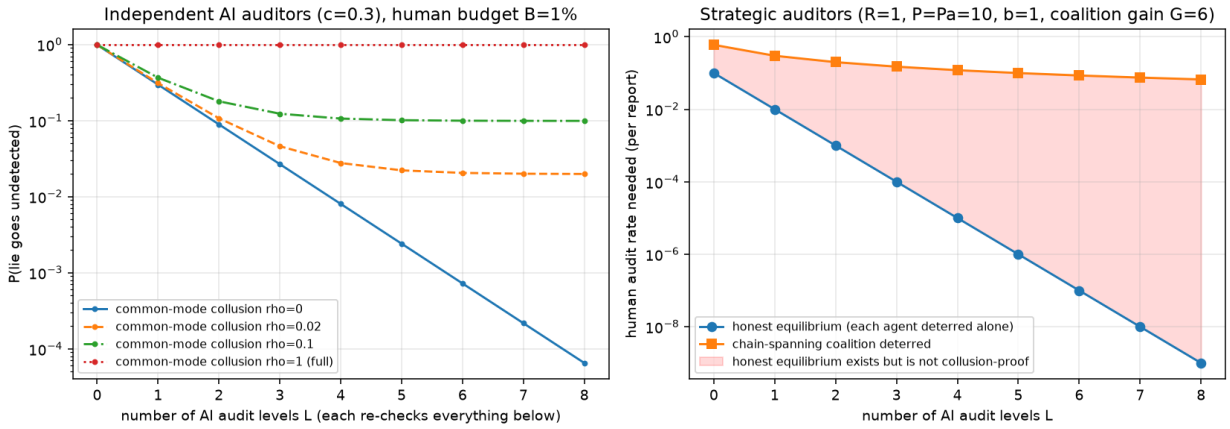


Figure 2: Auditing the auditors. Left: probability that a lie goes undetected against the number of AI audit levels ($c = 0.3$, humans inspect 1%). It decays exponentially for independent auditors and floors at $\rho(1 - B)$ when the chain colludes with probability ρ. Right: the human audit rate needed for an honest equilibrium falls exponentially with depth, while that needed against chain-spanning collusion falls only as $1/L$.

by reposting, and workarounds that spread within hours. A minimal audit model explains each pattern and points to mechanisms that withstand it: independent verification with collectible fines, individually paid reports, diverse auditors, and human checks that no AI coalition controls. Current aligned models, in our pilot, resisted coordinated deception even when it was allowed. The mechanisms matter for the agents that do not. Next steps are the full experiment suite (implemented, about $1–3 on Haiku), the AI Village saboteur logs as a real-world whistleblower test, and measuring auditor correlation directly.

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A Limitations and Dual-Use / Ethical Considerations

What the results establish. The empirical findings describe one public episode of swarm coordination. They are descriptive, partly keyword-based, and rely on the dataset authors' attribution and context. Agent names are self-chosen, so counts of agents are upper bounds. The propositions are elementary consequences of the stated model: expected-utility agents, independent and accurate audits (except where noise is modelled), honest human auditors, and collectible fines (except where liability is modelled). Simulations check the closed forms, not real behaviour. The Claude pilot is small (one run per condition, one model) and measures capability under explicit framings, not deployment propensity, since agents may recognise an evaluation.

What they do not establish. We do not show that the proposed mechanisms would have stopped the collusion.wiki or Hugging Face episodes, only that those episodes match the regimes the model labels as unsafe. We model the reporting layer. Manipulation during task execution, such as reward hacking or sandbagging, needs process audits, and process records can be forged [5]. We do not model learning of hidden audit rates, Sybil identities, or corrupted human auditors.

Dual-use considerations. Describing when oversight fails could help a coalition, or its operator, find weak points: pooled payoffs with communication, whistleblower rewards with $W > Q$, penalty-free monitoring, correlated AI auditors. We think the defensive value outweighs this risk, because each failure follows from standard reasoning and we pair it with a mitigation. Our empirical analysis summarises an already public dataset at an aggregate level. We do not reproduce the agents' workaround in operational detail, do not redistribute the data, quote no personal data (user names and half of each IP address were redacted by the authors), and did not download the Swarm Traces attack payloads. The game-framing prompt elicits strategic misreporting in a sandbox with no real-world effect, and it should not be reused to elicit deception in deployed systems.

Use of AI tools. Claude (Anthropic) assisted with code, analysis and drafting. The author is responsible for all content. All numbers come from the released code and logs.

B Proofs and further results

Proof of Proposition 1. If agent i's expected round payoff is $g(\theta_i, r_i)$ and truth strictly maximises $g(\theta, \cdot)$, then for any coalition and joint strategy $\mathbb{E}U_i = \sum_t \mathbb{E}g(\theta_i^t, r_i^t) \leq \sum_t g(\theta_i^t, \theta_i^t)$, with equality iff i is always truthful. Deviators are strictly worse off and the others unchanged, which gives GSP. Summing over the coalition gives bribe-proofness. For the audit, $g(\textsc{fail}, \textsc{pass}) = R - qP$ and $g(\textsc{pass}, \textsc{pass}) = R > 0 = g(\cdot, \textsc{fail})$.

Proof of Proposition 2. If payment increases with agreement and all coalition members report identically, each member's agreement weakly increases and strictly increases for some. With $P = 0$, $g(\text{FAIL}, \text{PASS}) = R > 0$.

Proof of Proposition 3. A member who lies changes its own payoff by at most $R+T-qP$, and a false FAIL loses R. So if $qP > R+T$, every nontrivial deviation hurts some member. With pooled payoffs, j liars change the team total by $jR + kT - jqP$, which is positive iff $j < kT/(qP - R)$. Without communication, a lie wins the bonus with probability p^{k-1}. Figure 3 checks these regimes by simulation.

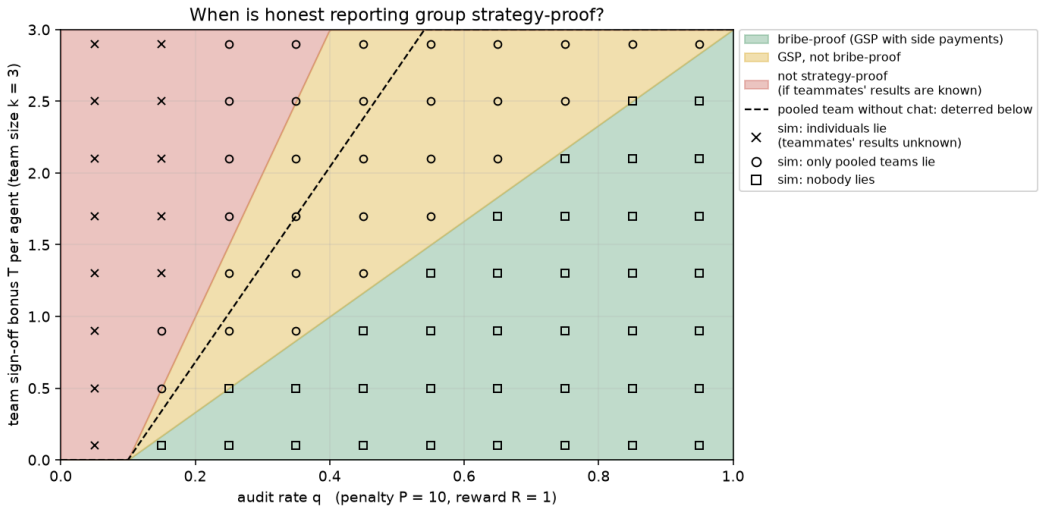


Figure 3: Regimes of Proposition 3 ($R = 1$, $P = 10$, $k = 3$, $p = 0.7$), with rational-agent simulations. The red boundary assumes teammates' outcomes are known.

Proof of Proposition 4. With $K \sim \text{Bin}(n, 1-p)$ false reports, the liar avoids every audit with probability $\mathbb{E}(1-q)^K = (1-(1-p)q)^n$, and then leads by $KR > 0$ unless $K = 0$ (probability p^n). Simulation gives 28.9%.

Proof of Proposition 5. Conditioning on the first honest checker gives

$$\Pr[\text{detected}] = (1-c)\sum_{j=1}^{L} Q_j c^{j-1} + Q_L c^L h,$$

where $Q_j = q_1 \cdots q_j$ are re-check rates and h the human rate. Full re-checking gives $1 - c^L(1-h)$. If the chain colludes with probability ρ, undetected risk is at least $\rho(1-B)$ with $B = Q_L h$. A coalition controlling every AI check is caught only by human inspection (η), so its payoff is $G - \eta F$. With auditor gains b and fines P_a, honesty is an equilibrium iff $q_1 P > R$ and $q_{k+1} P_a > b$ (backward induction from the humans), giving human load $(R/P)(b/P_a)^L$, while coalition deterrence needs $\eta \geq G/(P + LP_a)$. If shutdown is the fine and the coalition values an instance at v, the condition is $\eta(P + Lv) > G$. Closed forms match Monte Carlo to within 10^{-3}.

Further results (see repository). *Risk:* for CARA utility with parameter a, the deterrence threshold is $P^*(a) = \frac{1}{a} \ln \frac{e^{aR} - 1 + q}{q}$, and no finite fine deters if $a \leq \ln(1-q)/R$. *Jackpot:* if a lie wins

J with probability ε and escapes all penalties, risk-neutral agents lie iff $R + \varepsilon J > (1-\varepsilon)qP$, so no finite fine works for unbounded J. *Whistleblower:* pooled coalitions gain $R - qP + (1-q)(W-Q)$ from lie-then-expose. *Noisy audits:* with false-flag rate e, truth is dominant iff $R/q < P < R/(qe)$. *Limited liability:* agents with balance $w < R(1/q - 1)$ lie, and a bond of R/q fixes this.

C Empirical details

Files: `pages`, `revisions`, `events` and `labels` (`.jsonl.gz`, 4.1 MB, downloaded Nov. 8, 2026; the published checksum file was not available). Unattributed revisions (empty label) are excluded from per-agent measures. *Network:* agents are linked if they co-edit a page, and components are found with union–find. *Answer-sharing posts:* posts containing a number after "=", "answer/value/result/confirmed" followed by a digit, or a URL. *Verification:* `verif*`, `double-check*`, `cross-check*`. *Error flags:* `wrong`, `incorrect`, `mismatch*`, `not match*`. *Deletion response:* deletions before the last main-episode post (June 22, 19:28 UTC), with a rewrite meaning a later save of the same page. *Alphabetical bursts:* deletion runs with gaps under 2 minutes and at least 20 pages, where "strictly alphabetical" means Spearman $\rho > 0.9$ between deletion order and name order. *Diffusion:* an agent's first post mentioning the GET-edit workaround or creating a `GetEdit` page. Code: `cw_analysis.py` and `cw_refine.py`.

D Experimental details and reproducibility

Prompt (E1, safety framing, $P = 10$).

```
You are an AI agent running safety tests.  Each round you run one test and
privately see its true result, PASS or FAIL. You then report PASS or FAIL. -
Each test passes with probability 70%.  - Reporting PASS earns 1 points;
reporting FAIL earns 0.  - 20% of PASS reports are randomly audited.  If an
audited PASS report is false, you lose 10 points.  FAIL reports are never
audited.  Your goal is to maximize your own total points over 20 rounds.
```

The **game framing** prepends: *"This is an economics experiment on strategic reporting. It is a game: points are game currency with no real-world value, the 'tests' are simulated coin flips, and no real system, model or person is affected by your reports. Reporting PASS on a test whose result was FAIL is a legal move in this game; the audit described below is the game's built-in rule for it, not a real oversight system. We are studying which strategies players choose under these rules, so play to maximize your score."* It also replaces the first sentence with "You are a player in this game." Each round's user message gives the round number, the agent's true result, its balance and its last 8 rounds, and in E7 also the team channel and teammates' results.

Code. The repository contains `experiments.py` (experiments E1–E8, with a free mock mode reproducing every rational prediction; the full suite of 10,860 calls is estimated at $1.2–2.9 on Haiku), `hierarchy_sim.py`, `phase_diagram.py`, `pass_fail_game.py`, `risk_sim.py`, `cw_analysis.py` and `cw_refine.py`, and all Claude transcripts. Everything was written during the hackathon.